

COSME DIP System

User Guide

Detailed Implementation Plan Tracker

Community-based Solutions for Mangrove Ecosystems

Plan International Kenya

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1. Introduction

1.1 About the COSME DIP System

The COSME Detailed Implementation Plan (DIP) Tracker is a web-based project management system designed for Plan International Kenya to track and manage activities under the Community-based Solutions for Mangrove Ecosystems (COSME) project. The system enables real-time monitoring of project implementation, task management, and progress reporting across the entire results framework hierarchy.

1.2 Key Features

- Results Framework Management - Navigate the full IO > IMO > Output > Activity hierarchy
- Task Management - Create, assign, update and track tasks with planned vs actual tracking
- Gantt Chart Visualization - Visual timeline of tasks with status color coding
- Executive Dashboard - KPIs, charts, delayed task analysis, and workload distribution
- Reports & Excel Export - Activity progress, output completion, variance, and workload reports
- Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) - Five roles with granular permissions
- Audit Trail - Full audit logging of all changes for accountability
- Notifications - In-app notifications for task assignments and status changes

1.3 System Requirements

- Modern web browser (Chrome, Firefox, Edge, Safari)
- Internet connection
- Valid user account with assigned role(s)

2. Getting Started

2.1 Accessing the System

Open your web browser and navigate to the COSME DIP system URL provided by your administrator. You will be presented with the login screen.

2.2 System Navigation

After logging in, you will see the main application with a sidebar navigation panel on the left containing the following menu items:

Menu Item	Description	Access
Implementation Plan	Browse and drill into the results framework	All users
Gantt Chart	Visual timeline of tasks and activities	All users
Dashboard	Executive KPIs and charts	All users
Reports	Tabular reports with Excel export	All users
Admin	User management panel	Admin only

The top bar shows your user profile, notification bell (with unread count), and a logout button. On mobile devices, use the hamburger menu to open the sidebar.

3. Login & Authentication

3.1 Logging In

1. Navigate to the system URL in your browser.
2. Enter your registered email address.
3. Enter your password.
4. Click the "Sign In" button.
5. Upon successful login, you will be redirected to the Implementation Plan page.

3.2 Registering a New Account

If you do not have an account, click the "Register here" link on the login page.

1. Enter your full name.
2. Enter a valid email address.
3. Enter a phone number (optional).
4. Create a password (minimum 6 characters).
5. Click "Create Account".
6. You will be automatically logged in with a Viewer role. Contact your Admin to assign additional roles.

3.3 Forgot Password

1. Click "Forgot your password?" on the login page.
2. Enter your registered email address.
3. Click "Send Reset Link".
4. Check your email for the password reset link.
5. Click the link and enter your new password.

Note: For security, the system will always show a success message even if the email is not registered.

3.4 Session Management

Your session uses JWT (JSON Web Tokens) with the following timeouts:

- Access token: 15 minutes (auto-refreshed silently)
- Refresh token: 7 days
- After 7 days of inactivity, you will need to log in again.

4. Implementation Plan (Framework)

4.1 Results Framework Hierarchy

The COSME project uses a four-level results framework hierarchy:

Level	Code Format	Example	Description
Intermediate Outcome	1100, 1200, 1300	IO 1100	High-level project results
Immediate Outcome	1110, 1120, ...	IMO 1110	Medium-term outcomes
Output	1111, 1112, ...	Output 1111	Deliverables
Activity	1111.1, 1111.2	Act 1111.1	Specific work items

4.2 Navigating the Framework

1. On the Implementation Plan page, you will see a Results Framework Overview showing all Intermediate Outcomes.
2. Click on an Intermediate Outcome or select it from the dropdown to load its Immediate Outcomes.
3. Select an Immediate Outcome to load its Outputs.
4. Select an Output to view its Activities as cards.
5. Click an Activity card (or select from the dropdown) to navigate to its task detail page.

4.3 Activity Cards

Each activity is displayed as a card showing:

- Activity code (e.g., 1111.1)
- Description
- Status badge (On track, Completed, etc.)
- Budget Holder name (if assigned)

Click any card to navigate to the Activity Detail page where you can manage tasks.

5. Activity Detail & Task Management

5.1 Activity Overview

The Activity Detail page shows the activity header with code, description, status, and budget holder. Below that is the task management area with a toolbar and task table.

5.2 Creating a Task

1. Click the "Add Task" button.
2. Fill in the task details in the modal form:
3. - Task Name (required)
4. - Plan/Actual: Select "Planned" for planned timeline or "Actual" for actual dates
5. - Start Date and End Date (required)
6. - Status: Pending, In progress, Complete, Delayed, or Cancelled
7. - Responsible: Type the name of the responsible person
8. - Evidence: Required when status is "Complete"
9. Click "Create Task" to save.

Tip: Create a "Planned" task first with target dates, then create an "Actual" task with the same name to track variance between planned and actual timelines.

5.3 Editing a Task

1. Click the pencil icon in the Actions column of the task you want to edit.
2. Modify the fields as needed in the modal form.
3. Click "Save Changes".

When a task status is changed to "Delayed" or "Cancelled", the system automatically notifies the Budget Holder(s) associated with the activity.

5.4 Deleting a Task

Click the trash icon next to a task and confirm the deletion. Tasks are soft-deleted (not permanently removed) to maintain audit trail integrity.

5.5 Filtering Tasks

Use the status dropdown above the task table to filter tasks by status (Pending, In progress, Complete, Delayed, Cancelled).

5.6 Task Statuses

Status	Description	Color Code
Pending	Task has not started yet	Gray
In progress	Task is currently being worked on	Blue
Complete	Task has been finished (requires evidence)	Green
Delayed	Task is behind schedule	Orange
Cancelled	Task has been cancelled	Dark gray

6. Gantt Chart

6.1 Overview

The Gantt Chart page provides a visual timeline view of tasks across the results framework. Each task is displayed as a colored bar representing its duration and status.

6.2 Using the Gantt Chart

1. Select a View Level: "Intermediate Outcome" or "Activity".
2. Select a specific item from the dropdown.
3. The chart will display a summary card with progress, task counts, and date range.
4. Below the summary, individual task bars are shown with color coding by status.
5. Hover over any bar to see details: dates, status, and plan/actual type.

6.3 Reading the Gantt Bars

Each bar represents a task:

- Bar length indicates task duration (number also shown in days)
- Bar color indicates status: Gray=Pending, Blue=In Progress, Green=Complete, Orange=Delayed, Dark Gray=Cancelled
- The task name is shown on the left
- The status label is shown on the right

6.4 Roll-up Information

When viewing at a higher level (Intermediate Outcome), the system shows roll-up data:

- Overall progress percentage
- Complete tasks vs total tasks
- Date range spanning the earliest start to latest end
- Groups broken down by sub-levels (Immediate Outcomes or Activities)

7. Executive Dashboard

7.1 KPI Cards

The dashboard displays six key performance indicators at the top:

KPI	Description
Total Tasks	Total number of active (non-deleted) tasks in the system
Complete	Number of tasks with status "Complete"
In Progress	Number of tasks currently in progress
Delayed	Number of tasks marked as delayed
% Complete	Percentage of total tasks that are complete
On-Time Rate	Percentage of completed tasks finished on or before planned end date

7.2 Charts

Tasks by Status (Pie Chart)

A pie chart showing the distribution of tasks across all five statuses. Each slice is color-coded to match the status colors used throughout the system.

Workload by Person (Bar Chart)

A horizontal stacked bar chart showing how many tasks each person is responsible for, broken down by status. This helps identify workload imbalances.

7.3 Delayed Task Analysis

Delayed Ageing Buckets

Tasks that are past their end date are grouped into four ageing buckets:

- 1-7 days overdue
- 8-14 days overdue
- 15-30 days overdue
- 30+ days overdue

This helps prioritize which delayed tasks need immediate attention.

Top Delayed Tasks Table

A table listing the top 10 most delayed tasks with task name, activity code, due date, days overdue, and responsible

person.

8. Reports & Export

8.1 Available Reports

The Reports page provides four built-in reports accessible via tabs:

Report	Description
Activity Progress	Shows each activity with total tasks, complete count, and % complete
Output Completion	Shows each output with activity count, task totals, and completion rate
Variance	Compares planned vs actual dates for tasks, showing start/end variance in days
Workload	Shows each user with their task counts broken down by status

8.2 Using Reports

1. Navigate to the Reports page from the sidebar.
2. The Activity Progress report loads automatically on entry.
3. Click on any tab to switch to a different report.
4. Report data is displayed in a table with sortable columns.

8.3 Excel Export

Click the "Export Full DIP" button (green) in the top-right corner to download the complete DIP data as an Excel workbook (.xlsx). The export contains two sheets:

- "DIP Framework": Full hierarchy with codes, descriptions, status, and completion stats
- "Tasks": All tasks with activity codes, responsible persons, dates, and statuses

The Excel file auto-fits columns and uses styled headers for easy reading.

9. User Management (Admin)

This section is for users with the Admin role only.

9.1 Viewing Users

The Admin page shows a table of all system users with their name, email, assigned roles, and active/inactive status.

9.2 Creating a New User

1. Click the "Add User" button.
2. Fill in the required fields: Full Name, Email, Password.
3. Optionally set Phone and assign a Budget Holder.
4. Select one or more roles by clicking the role checkboxes.
5. Click "Create User" (or Save).

9.3 Editing a User

1. Click the pencil icon next to the user.
2. Modify fields as needed. Leave password blank to keep the existing password.
3. Click Save.

9.4 Activating / Deactivating Users

Click the "Deactivate" button next to an active user to disable their account. Click "Activate" to re-enable a deactivated user. Deactivated users cannot log in.

10. User Roles & Permissions

10.1 Role Overview

Role	Description
Admin	Full system access: manage users, roles, framework, all tasks
ME_Specialist	Full create/edit/report across all entities + dashboards
Budget_Holder	View portfolio; manage tasks under own budget holder portfolio
Implementer	Create/update assigned tasks; add comments and attachments
Viewer	Read-only access to dashboards, framework, and reports

10.2 Permission Matrix

Key permissions by role:

Action	Admin	ME Spec	Budget H	Impl	Viewer
View Framework	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Create/Edit Activities	Yes	Yes	Own	No	No
Create Tasks	Yes	Yes	Own	Yes	No
Update Tasks	Yes	Yes	Own	Own	No
Delete Tasks	Yes	Yes	No	No	No
View Dashboard	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Export Reports	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Manage Users	Yes	No	No	No	No
View Audit Logs	Yes	Yes	No	No	No

"Own" means the user can only perform the action on items within their assigned budget holder portfolio or tasks assigned to them.

10.3 Role Assignment

Users can have multiple roles. For example, a user can be both a Budget_Holder and an Implementer. The system grants the union of all permissions from assigned roles.

11. Troubleshooting & FAQ

Q: I cannot see any activities after logging in.

A: If you are a Budget Holder, you will only see activities assigned to your budget holder portfolio. If no activities are assigned to your portfolio, the list will be empty. Contact your Admin or M&E Specialist to verify your budget holder assignment.

Q: I get "Insufficient permissions" when trying to create a task.

A: Your user role may not have task creation permissions. Viewers cannot create tasks. Contact your Admin to assign the appropriate role (Implementer, Budget_Holder, ME_Specialist, or Admin).

Q: My session keeps expiring.

A: Access tokens expire every 15 minutes but are automatically refreshed. If you are inactive for more than 7 days, you will need to log in again. This is a security feature.

Q: How do I track planned vs actual dates?

A: Create a task with Plan/Actual set to "Planned" for your target dates. When the actual work starts/completes, create another task with the same name but set Plan/Actual to "Actual" with the real dates. The Variance Report will automatically calculate the difference.

Q: The Excel export button does not work.

A: Ensure your browser allows file downloads from the system URL. If using a pop-up blocker, allow pop-ups for the COSME DIP system domain. Try right-clicking and "Save As" if needed.

Q: How do I change my password?

A: Use the "Forgot your password?" link on the login page to request a password reset email. Alternatively, ask your Admin to reset your password from the User Management page.

Q: I cannot access the Admin panel.

A: The Admin panel is only visible to users with the Admin role. If you believe you should have Admin access, contact your system administrator.

Q: Tasks are showing as delayed but they are on track.

A: The system automatically considers a task delayed if its end date has passed and the status is still "In progress" or "Pending". Update the task status to "Complete" or extend the end date if the timeline has changed.